

Reminiscences

of George Nidever and Charles Brown of the Early History of Santa Barbara and the Fining of the Woman (Indian) on San Nicholas Island.

Q. What is your name?

A. My name is George Nidever. I was born in the State of Tennessee in 1802.

Q. How old were you when you left home?

A. I was a boy, quite small, not more than 10 years old, when I left Tennessee and went to Arkansas and Mexico.

Q. ~~What~~ did you do when you were in Arkansas and Mexico?

A. ~~Followed~~ ~~Followed~~ hunting. Traveled about from the time I was 18 years old and have been traveling ever since. I went to Texas and came back to Arkansas. There was a company coming to the Rocky Mts. in 1830. We traveled in Arkansas, given by treaty to the Cherokee Indians. I had to leave.

Q. What was your father's occupation?

A. Farmer

Q. That means hunter in those days?

A. Yes - small farmer - not like they do now.

Q. What started you to come to California?

A. It was a company coming to the Rocky Mountains for two years to trap beaver. I was a good shot and they wanted me to come out.

Q. What did you come out here to do?

A. The company were nearly all killed. Capt. Walker was coming across and they did not make much and said they were coming to California. Well I came with them.

Q. How many were there in the company?

A. Thirty-six when they came here.

Q. How many started? Ans. 48.

A. What become of the rest? Ans. Some stopped.

Q. Did you meet any Indians on the way? Ans. Yes.

Q. Did you have any trouble with them?

A. We were troubled all the while with them till we came to California. There was some trouble here but not with the Indians, but Indians from the north.

Q. Did you have any fights with them? Ans. Yes.

Q. Did you shoot at them? Ans. Yes, we killed 34 in one place.

Q. What tribe? Ans. Piutes.

Q. Did they kill any of your folks? Ans. No, they did not.

Q. You had guns and they had bows and arrows? Ans. Yes, and spades.

Q. What year was that when you came here?

A. 1834. Came into Monterey first. Struck the coast there at St. Joseph. Monterey was the capital. Struck the coast at a place called Gilroy.

Q. Packed, did you? Ans. Yes.

A. Did you walk a good deal of the way? Ans. Yes, we had to kill our meat all the way.

Q. Did you live on meat all the way? Ans. Nothing but meat. Did not take any flour.

Q. Was there any time when you could not find any game?

A. There was a time when we could not find much, but always killed something.

Q. What did you kill - what kind of meat? Ans. Buffalo, elk, deer, bear.

Q. How long were you coming from Tennessee here?

A. I left about 10 years old. It got here in '34 - several years on the way. Sometimes we would be stopped 2 or 3 years in a place trapping; caught (cached?) a good many beaver but lost them by the Indians.

Q. What did they do? Ans. Took the skins. They were worth \$4.00 a lb.

Q. When you got here did you find any Americans?

A. Some Americans in 1834, about 50 or 60 in the country.

Q. How many Indians did you find here? Ans. More than white men.

Q. Ask him if he remembers anything about the old Missions. Tell us anything you remember about it.

A. They had cattle and horses. The priests had charge of everything; raised corn and wheat; raised enough to live on; had a good many cattle and lived on them.

Q. What did you do when you came here?

A. Hunted sea otter 20 or 30 years. It must be learned; we had no rifles like we have now, but one-barrel old fashioned rifle.

Q. How many Indians did you ever kill?

A. I could not tell how many. I know I killed four. There were only 36 of us; we had got well used to the Indians. We wanted to get them on us. Finally they followed us and finally they intended to take us. We did not know any names and that was called Mary Run, Salt Lake, and there was a trail and the trail went through a bunch of willows. We knew they intended to take us and at about 200 yards we turned off, and as soon as we turned off they came out. They lived in villages. Every village has its captain. They came up. The first party coming up we met them, 15 of us, and about 200 yards away we tied the horses altogether. There were 15 of us and these 15 were choice shots. They came walking right up within 40 or 50 yards of us and they were kind of falling to - every fellow had his hands full of arrows - and we commenced firing all 15 shots at once. There were 34 Indians killed, the rest ran away. You were asking me how many I killed. About two days afterward we were out, me and the captain. There were five. I got off to one side to the left and walked up to a place where we were to meet. They had not come yet. I saw two Indians coming. I thought they were after me, but they had not seen me. They ran along and kept looking back. I thought they had shot a man and so I thought I would kill one. I had a brother killed by them. Finally they came to a point of the hill. I shot. I killed them both. They just fell and rolled.

Q. Where about did you hit them?

A. The first was shot on the left side and killed instantly.

Q. Ask him if he did not see any friendly Indians, any he had confidence in.

A. No, could not trust any. There was what is called the Snake Indians, about the best, but could not trust them.

Q. Ask him if he had anything to do with the Apache Indians

A. Yes, coming through New Mexico. Saw some there.

Q. Were not they friendly? A. Not very. They would steal.

Q. ~~Was it there you settled down first?~~ Was it there you settled down first?

A. Yes. I came to Monterey and went up to San Francisco; was at San Joaquin in a boat and come down to San Francisco. The ship California was there and was coming down to Santa Barbara and saw some Americans and told them they ought to come here. When I came here it was in 1835 in the city of Santa Barbara. There were 17 or 18 at first the year I came to Santa Barbara, 85.

Q. This woman - how came she to be left on the Island?

A. Sparks took them all down to the beach, She had a child back on the land and wanted to go back and finally they let her go and she did not come back and they went away and she was left there. Sparkes came and said there was a woman left on the island. All expected she could not live.

- Q. Who was Sparkes and how came to to go for the Indians?
- A. The Mexicans sent them to bring them off. The schooner got lost just afterwards. They calculated to go back. All thought that the woman would not live long, so they did not go back. The schooner went to San Francisco and got lost.
- Q. Why did you want to bring the Indians off anyway?
- A. They wanted them at the Mission anyhow and the Government sent to fetch them off.
- Q. Did the Indians go to work in the Mission, these particular ones?
- A. They sent them to work different places, those they brought off.
- Q. How did the Indians get on there in the first place?
- A. Born and raised there - never been on the coast.
- Q. Did you see the Indians on there before they were taken off?
- A. No, I never saw them.
- Q. How came you to find this woman was left there? Did you see her tracks?
- A. Yes, it was three times before I found her. I went over. The priests here wanted me to hunt for her.
- Q. What priest was it? A. Father Gonzales, after Sanchez.
- Q. How long was it before you found her after you went to the Island?
- A. I found her pretty quick. We had been all over the Island and it was 12 o'clock I suppose. It was very pretty weather. Capt. Brown was with me. Me and him walked over to the head of the Island and we saw a track where she had been to the water. We did not find her that evening. Finally went and brought over several Indians on board of the crew - two or three white men the rest Indians. We took all of them ashore except the cook. We thought she would try and hide and we scattered off two or three hundred yards apart. She had a little house made of brush and had a fire; sitting by the fire with a little knife; she was working with it; she had a bone. All came up and looked at her well. She had a heap of roots. That is what she lived on and had little sacks to carry them in. As soon as we sat down she put a lump of them to roast on the fire. Finally we got ready to go and we made signs for her to come with us. She picked up her things to take them on board. She did not appear to be seasick at all and was contented. Next day we moved ashore and stayed there a month and killed a good many otter. She appeared to like everything we had to eat. When we got ready to come we made signs we were coming and she was very willing to come. She came here.
- Q. What did she say when she came to the beach and saw them on horseback?
- A. She said it in her own tongue; looked up and down the coast and thought it was an island. It was a month or five weeks after she landed before she died.
- Q. What did she have on when you found her on the Island?
- A. Had her dress made of bird skins, out of what they ~~call~~ call shag (a species of black duck). We made her clothes right off; made her petticoats right off. Gave her shirts.
- Q. What did she make the petticoats of? A. Clothes we had. see.
- Q. Men's clothes would not make good petticoats. A. No, cut them up, you/
- Q. Dressed her in style, did you? A. Yes, made her presentable here.
- Q. How did she sew those bird skins together?
- A. Got the sinews of a seal. It made quite a nice thread and she had needles of bone.
- Q. What did she do with the dress?
- A. The dress the priests have. I think they sent it to Rome. My wife ~~let~~ let them have them all, her needles and all the things.

she had a demijohn to carry her water, held a gallon or 1½ gallons, made out of rushes and stopped with asphaltum. She was making another. Walked up and down. She would walk every day. Finally I see she had a fire made and had small round stones heating of them, and she put them in the asphaltum and threw in these hot stones and it would run all over and make them as tight as a demijohn.

- Q. How did she make fire? A. Out of sticks.
- Q. No matches? A. No, she made it with a stick rubbing a stick. I have done it myself.
- Q. Did you bring those things off that she used for water?
- A. Yes, was fetched here. Scattered in different places, different persons getting them. She said her child was eaten up by wolves or wild dogs, which were on the Island.
- Q. Ask him if none of the Indians were understood what she said.
- A. No, there was none of the Indians here that understood her good; I tried to find some tribe that could talk to her and finally got some woman that could talk a little.
- Q. Where did that old woman come from that could talk to her a little?
- A. She was raised on San Nicholas.
- Q. You say there was one woman who could understand her a little?
- A. She was fetched from some of the islands.
- Q. Did she tell that woman her child was eaten up by the dogs? A. No.
- Q. How did you know?
- A. From her signs. She thought that the dog had eaten it. There are a great many dogs there, wild dogs; they were poisoned off some years after.
- Q. She used to live with you till she died?
- A. Yes, died right here in this room.
- Q. What seemed to be the matter with her?
- A. Just kind of give up. Could not tell what was the matter. Indians when they are sick naturally give up, don't care if they live or not.
- Q. How old was she? A. About 50; that's what the priests thought.
- Q. Did you hunt any after that?
- A. Yes, killed lots of otter there, 70 in one month.
- Q. Have you got any Indian relics here? A. None now except this (shows).
- Q. Where did you get it. A. It came from the islands, I don't know which island.
- Q. Who found it?
- A. I don't know. It is a weapon to fix in a stick. I was in the war with the Mexicans. This is a medal (shows medal). Soldiers in the Mexican war had them. I was in California here with Fremont. The Mexican war commenced in 1846. I entered in 1848.
- Q. Where did you come from? A. A native of Pennsylvania.
- Q. What descent was he? A. German.
- Q. Could you tell me something about otter hunting? I expect you have seen some pretty hard times shooting otter.
- A. No.
- Q. How do you hunt them? A. From boats.
- Q. How many boats do you generally take? A. One time there were six.
- Q. How many shots do you have to fire to get an otter?
- A. It's a hard animal to kill.
- Q. How many have you killed in your life?
- A. I have killed 13 in one day, places where they were never hunted before. They they were worth \$20 apiece.
- Q. You made a pretty good day's work. A. There were three with me.

- Q. Do they keep under water more than a seal? A. About the same as seals.
- Q. Do otter ever come on shore on rocks?
- A. No. I saw a wounded one once on a rock, that's all. An otter never gets wet alive; after they die they get wet.
- Q. How do you know they get wet before you get to them?
- A. When they take them in the boat just as dry as on land right out of the water. I am 82 and would like to go on an exploring expedition. I killed my last otter when I was 70. When I first came here the Americans and English used to come from the northwest and go up there and fetch 12 or 13 canoes and come along the coast here. That is what killed off the otter and run them off. They used to rob the people here. There were so many of them, could not fight them. Sparkes he got robbed. Took their skins and provisions and everything they could get hold of. Went over to the Island, and Sparkes said, what are we to do even if they come? I said I would fight first and, if too many, run. There were 13 canoes. We had a great fight. There were 4 hunters there and 3 in our canoes and a Portuguese. We agreed not to run. Finally they came. We were off to sea running otter and as soon as they saw us they came as fast as they could; went very fast and just as we got ashore there was one boat 70 or 80 yards from us. One boat got ashore before the other was outside. This man that got ashore he shot. He lost the powder out of his gun and did not kill the Indian. Sparkes got ashore next. He shot and hit the Indian and he fell and got up again and ran ashore. I had always two or three guns. When I got ashore I shot. The foremost fell and then Sparkes and the other man killed three.
- Q. Where did the Indians get their ammunition?
- A. Brig went - this was an English brig - went ~~xxx~~ after the Indians, and Americans too. They got the Indians down to hunt otter. The captain told them to kill us and take all the skins we had.
- Q. What year was that?
- A. That was in 1836. This woman was found 18 years after, in 1853.
- Q. Will you ask him if while she lived she seemed contented and happy?
- A. Yes. She would go around to different houses and dance.
- Q. Did she dance? A. Indian dance.
- Q. Did she go around and visit neighbors?
- A. Yes, all over town and the Mission.
- Q. All alone? A. No. Always a party with her, 20 or 30.
- Q. Were they Indians and Mexicans with her? A. Yes.
- Q. She was a curiosity.
- A. Yes. You see the people who passed in the vessels that passed here heard there was an Indian woman who had lived alone on an island 17 years and they would not believe it until they came to see her.
- Q. How was it you did not find her the second time you were there?
- A. Bad weather.
- Q. Did they pay you anything for finding her?
- A. No. They offered me \$1000 for her, to take her around and exhibit.
- Q. I thought you would have taken \$1000 for her.
- A. It did not look right to sell a person.
- Q. How did she look? Was she good looking?
- A. Very good looking and weighed about 100 or 130 lbs.
- Q. How do you suppose the woman caught the shags? A. At night.
- Q. How did she get her seal blubber?
- A. They slept on the rocks and she caught them.

- Q. What did she eat?
A. She would eat seal when she could get them. She had fishhooks made of bone and line made of the sinews of the seal back. She was skinning a piece of seal when we found her.
Q. Ask him if he remembers how her dress was made, A. Out of the skins.
Q. What was it made like?
A. The skins were sown. I cannot hardly tell. Feathers all laid down.
Q. Had it arms to it? A. Yes, she had cover round and looked quite well.
Q. She seemed to be glad to see you when you found her?
A. She was glad to see us and was not afraid of us.
Q. Did you ever see any of the Indian skulls with two rows of teeth?
A. No, I never saw any. I believe I have heard of it. I never went much with Indians. They wanted to kill me.
Q. Did they steal your horses?
A. Yes. We were out after meat once and they got after us. There were six of us and about forty Indians.

Charles Brown's Statement

Born in Prussia. My name is really Carl Ditman. Ever since I left Germany I go by the name of Charles Brown. I went in an English vessel and shipped in a man's place as Charles Brown. I was born in 1822.

- Q. You always followed the sea?
A. For 10 or 12 years. Then I came here and here I stick. I came here in 1844 with Capt. Wilson and have been here ever since.
Q. When did you commence otter hunting?
A. The year afterwards. Sent us down to the Island of Cerros, about 600 miles from here. I hunted there and built a boat of Monterey pine. The brig left us for she went down to Mexico hunting. Old man Sparkes had charge of her. I built a boat and hunted, coming up to Memmosa (?). Made the most hunt there.
Q. How did you come to go over to San Nicholas? Did the Padre want you to go and get the Indian Woman?
A. Nidever settled at San Nicholas. He had a little vessel and he went on to San Nicholas before I went on there and he could not do anything with one boat. He said, I wish you would get a boat and go hunting with me. I said I would build a boat. He said he had seen a sign on this woman and he was there afterward and could never find the track again. When I went there it was a stormy day and we could not go ashore for three days. We let the anchor go. He thought it was in a bunch of kelp but it was under a rock. When the swells came I said we have got to get out of this. I said we have to wait till slack water, because the flue of your anchor is in the rock. We all hauled and when the swell came on us all had to let go, so he said to leave it this way. So we stayed for three days and got anchored all right. Nothing broke. Then after we went ashore the Old Man got the spyglass to see for otter. We got on the head of the Island. The Old Man got tired. I went around the head of the Island and found tracks of the woman, so I went back and told the old gentleman the woman was alive. He said how do you know? I said I have found her track. He said it must be some of our Indians. I said our Indians have got bigger tracks than that. And he said, well if

you think she is alive let us hunt for her and take all the man ashore. We went up to the head of the Island. There was a kind of hill in the middle. I put my Indians 200 yards apart. I did not know what kind of a woman she was. I thought she might bite or scratch, and went from one side of the Island to the other and we could not see the hill. She was sitting on the side of the hill eatching us, and when we got across to the Indians I said there is nothing here and I said go back. There was a basket and some feathers. She catched the shag and had a coat made like a coat without sleeves - had it nicely covered with sealskin. I said to the Indians you go to the hill and scatter the feathers and things in the basket and if she is alive she will find them. And we found them all gathered up again the same day and put in the basket. I went around another way. The Indians found it all picked up. We took a good many things to the camp before and when I came back I see the tracks again and I said now I am going to have you sure. I am going to track you.

~~WexwentxxupxxtoxxthexheadxxofxxthexIslandxxxTherexwasxxakindxxofxxhill
inxthexmiddlexxxxxxpxmxix~~

In San Nicholas there is moss growing over just like this carpet. I got half way up and then I see her. She had something to carry and made small stages and she rested. When I went up a little higher I see three huts made out of whalebone. I thought to myself she is in there. I peeped in and there was no signs there. I thought to myself where in the world can she be? I stayed on the highest part and saw the Indians going where I told them. I looked and I looked and saw something like a crow sitting on a whalebone. I said to Myself what is that? So when I came to find out it was her I took my gun and stuck my hat on and held it up to make signs to the Indians. I did not know if she would bite or scratch. I motioned the Indians to come along.

She had a brush fence about two feet high to break the wind and right in front she sat facing me, The sun was coming her in Her face. She was skinning a seal before I came up to her. The dog when he noticed me he began to growl. I thought if she ~~knewxxx~~ should run. I stepped right around her and she bowed as if she knew me before and when the Indians came up they all kneeled down. When she saw there were some of her color she held out some of her food like an onion. She got out some of them and offered them all some and offered me some too; but I did not eat.

Old man Nidever was itting on the point. He would not go any further and we had a good deal of trouble for him to come. At last he came. He made a motion sign and she was kind of scared. So Old Man Nidever said to the Indians, in case she would not come could not we take her by force. I said no, she is not afraid. So I took her by the shoulder and said Varmoose and she understood at once. I took everything she had and she took a big seal head in basket and that was all. We all had something to carry. Then she with a ~~strangexkindxxofxxsteplike~~, little brand of fire and she took that away and wobbled along with a strange kind of steplike, until we came to a place in the beach where there was water. We all had a drink there and we told her to go right along. Then we came to another watering place about 50 feet down the bank and they all went down there and she went too. She sat down there and we watched to see what she would do. She washed herself all over. He hair was all rotted away and kind of bleached by the sun. We got to the vessel and she kneeled down. We had a stove on deck and she crawled to the stove. We gave

her a piece of biscuit and she ate like a good fellow.

It came on to blow. Old Man Nidever had some bedticking and made her a dree and gave her a man's shirt. She had nothing but a coat on, made of birdskins, got no sleeves, sewn with the sinews of animals she found on the beach. Anyway we took her on board and we lay there for three days, and while we were laying there I made her a skirt out of bedticking. She was ticled to death. There was a lot of wild dogs there.

Q. We want to know how it was she was left there and how the first Indians came there.

A. Early times I suppose all the islands were settled with Indians. Northwest Indians used to come to hunt and shoot the Indians just for mischief.

Q. How did she come to be left there?

A. I only know from what I have heard from Old Man Nidever; built a vessel called "Better than Nothing." They catshed this family there on San Nicholas and took them all away except her, and when she came back to camp she found everybody gone. She had two children. She shhok her breast meaning one nursing and one with teeth. She found they were all gone and she commenced to halloo and hunted around and saw the tracks and saw they went to the lower part of the Island. When she got there she found the vessels going away and she called "Manyanna," but it never came and they took the two children, all except her. They made signs for her to come back. She put her head on the ground and cried and they never came. She talked some words, "Kanake" - some kind of Indian - mixed it all up. The priest here had all the Indians in Santa Barbara and Santa Inaz to see if they understood her. They could understand some words but not all. They got baptized and they made her a Christian and everything. A steamer came up from below. The captain offered to take her up and show her, but Old Man Nidever would not agree to anything. She died. They gave her green corn and melon and that set her over. Shen she was over at the Island a month she camped out with them and lived on what they did and she was perfectly well. She would go off and get wood and water for herself and come back again and sit in camp and play like a child. There was a little otter (see Note) and she lodged a stick and hung it over for the sun not to shine in her eyes. She made baskets of the grass that grows on the Island. She had leaves for baskets, dozen or so never finished, worked on one and then the other, never finishing them. That is the way she passed her time away. Her teeth. She had solid teeth but they were worn away to the gums eating that tough stuff. When I brought her to the camp I took the skin of the otter and threw the carcass to the water and she saw it. She made signs it was to eat and she held it up. She liked potatoes, rice, fish. She did not ~~xxxx~~ eat much, but often, just like a child. She would take a bone and suck it.

When we left the Island it was pretty rough and we made her go below in the cabin and old man Nidever said we better turn back. She would not stay there but made a sign to pray for the wind to go down. She had named all the islands. I don't recollect the names. She had names for all of them. When we came to Santa Barbara beach there was nobody living there except old man Nidever. Seeing the boys coming along on horses she thought it was awful and when she saw the cattle crawled on the sand beach on her hands and knees.

- Q. Tell me about the ship that went and fetched the rest of the Indians.
A. Party of hunters, I believe; a little vessel. They landed at Santa Barbara.
Q. How did they know the Indians were there?
A. Went around the islands, probably found the Indians there and took them right off.
Q. How do you suppose they went? A. I suppose of their own free will.
A. Do you know what became of the Indians? A. They all died out.
Q. Where were they carried to? A. San Pedro. They say the men were strong Indians.
Q. How many were there?
A. I think seven. They were taken off before I came here. It was only the woman I caught and helped to take off. She was not wild. They all ask me if she was wild. Her hair was kind of rotten, bleached kind of red. She had been there 17 years all a lone and she made signs she had been sick, living in the dirt for days. She could not move, all alone. She was down sick, could not move, and got well.
Q. How did you get the story of her child?
A. The story they told she went back to get the child. They did not know anything about it. I understand she made signs so plain - she showed two fingers for two children and she shook her breast; one was sucking and the other had teeth. She sucked her fingers.
Q. How did ~~you~~ make you understand that they took off the children?
A. They told come back tomorrow, "manyanna" - made plain signs - never came back. She could see us the day before when we were on the head of the island and showed fingers. She would not come down until we had stumbled right over her.
Q. Then she did not want to go off. A. S he did not want to come.
Q. If she had felt a strong desire she would have come.
A. That is the Indian way.
Q. Did it occur to her to go to them, to want to see what happened? She might have seen you. A. Yes, before.
Q. Probably seen hunters before.
A. They all told she had been dead for years. They knew there was a woman left there. Nobody hunted for her and when Old Man Nidever saw the tracks thought she was dead until I found the tracks again, and then we hunted for her.
Q. What became of the dress?
A. Mr. Nidever gave it to the priests and they sent it to Rome. She had bone needles with eyes drilled in and she had a knife made with bone and another with a piece of wood, that she had when I caught her cleaning the sealskin. She had nails pointed for catching fish with. She had the rope nicely twisted with sinews and had it twisted as true as any ropemake could make, and she had bottles made of grass about the size of a gallon demijohn. We found some dishes of wood with handles.
Q. What became of all these things?
A. I gave them to Nidever. If we had taken care of the woman and shown her we could have made a hatful of money. Captain of the steamer gave news that we had caught a wild woman.
Q. Was she baptized here? A. Yes, at the Mission.
Q. Do you know the name they gave her. A. Maria, something.
Q. They could not find out what her Indian name was?
A. No. Juana Maria I think she was named. The priests tried hard to find her life story, but she broke off into gibberish nobody could understand. Had Indians from Santa Barbara, Ventura, Santa Inez - they could not understand. Understood some words but not right through.

Q. Did she seem quite happy?

A. Happy as a lady. Shw was dancing when anybody came. Then she ~~slift~~ up her dress and made signs that I made her dress. While I was making her dress she tried to sew too. I had to thread her needle. She took this hand and put it through and handed it through like a shoemaker. She was content enough, if they had kept her from green corn, pumpkins and squash. Old Man Nidever told me he thought she would die the day before. She thought she was going to die. Nidever thought she would die that night when she came from the Island. I took baskets that was hanging. She got up from her bed the night before she went away and took a basket from the sycamore tree and threw the feathers out. One of the new baskets she gave to me. She lived two days after we left (Nidever and myself for San Francisco).

Q. I don't see what objection there could have been to take and show her.

A. Made money for her. People gave her money here. She did not know what money was. Clothes tickled her. She was only used to bird-skin coats. I suppose it was often cold weather and she put the feathers next to her skin. On the mainland, if they had worked it right and kept her on her food she might have been alive yet. She was about 45 or 50 when we found her, because she walked with a kind of stoop. Singular part of it, probably seen people before. She made signs that she had seen men go by.

Q. Did she give you any idea that she had seen the men before?

A. No. Ships going that way and this, but nobody came for her.

Q. Had she anything rough over her head?

A. Nothing whatever. She held up her hand that way when the Indians came up and they let her know if she did run they would catch her.

Q. Did you say she spoke some words "Kanake?"

A. Yes. From one of the men that had the little schooner named "Williams." She got the name "Better than Nothing."

Q. Mr. Nidever thought the priests hired them to go and get the Indians off.

A. I don't think so. Maybe so. I came here in 1844. The priests had all the control.

Q. What was the old Presidio? A. Barracks for the soldiers.

Q. How was it you reenlisted in an English ship?

A. Left the Prussian ship.

Note: After copying the above statements I went down this P.M. (amrch 16, 1882) and called on Mr. Carl Ditman for an explanation regarding certain obscure statements in the above. Being a German and speaking broken English accounts largely for many of the inaccuracies. Regarding the root resembling an onion, he says the Spanish or Mexican name is "Cocometas," that the little "otter" referred to was a very small one which "she hung up by a string and played with as a cat would a mouse suspended in the same way." That they had Indians from different tribes to talk with her but could not recollect which tribe could understand her best. That the Old Man Nidever started from Santa Barbara for San Francisco two days before she died and that Capt. Nidever made her coffin before he started.

J. T.

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